Conference Committees

- WHO
- ECOSOC
- **HCC**
- EU
- Press Corps

MUN Procedures

- Committee Session
    1) Roll Call
        - All countries called, delegate responds with “Present” or “Present and Voting”
    2) General Speaker’s List
        - Chosen delegates give opening speech
    3) Moderated Caucus
        - Speaking rules apply
    4) Unmoderated Caucus
        - Informal session, delegates can walk around and talk to other delegates
    5) Drafted Resolutions
        - Done with multiple delegates
    6) Voting
        - Delegates vote for best resolution

MUN Terminology

- Moderated Caucus
    - Short statements/comments from delegates on sub-issues
    - If someone wants to speak on the subject, they must raise their placard and wait for the chair to call on them
- Unmoderated Caucus
    - Free movement
    - Talk to other delegates
    - Form alliances
    - Brainstorm resolutions

- Floor
    - Opportunity to speak
- Motion
    - Suggest an action
        - Extend debate time
        - Vote on resolutions
- Second
    - Agree with another delegate's motion
- Objection
    - Disagree with another delegate's motion
- Abstain
    - If a delegate is unsure about their vote they can choose not to say yes or no definitively
        - Does not fully agree
        - Agrees enough not to vote against

MUN Points

- Question or suggestion made by a delegate to the chair
- Usually regarding their comfort
- Types of points :
    - Point of Order
        - Objection to a procedure
        - The chair has made a mistake
        - Parliamentary Procedures are not done correctly
        - Must be made
        - Must say point of order whilst raising their placard
        - May interrupt a speaker who has the floor

- Point of Inquiry
    - For clarification
- Point of Information
    - To add onto another speaker statement/resolution
    - To bring down the resolution
    - Must be formulated as a short question
    - May NOT interrupt speaker who has the floor
    - Must be directed to the chair, even though it is aimed at the speaker
    - Max 2 times
- Point of Personal Privilege
    - When a delegate feels uncomfortable
    - Room too hot / too cold
    - May interrupt speaker to request for change in atmosphere
- Point of Parliament Inquiry
    - Point of info directed at chair regarding the rules of procedure

Committee Overview

- Committee Summary :
- Agenda :
    - Topic 1 - The Indochinese Independence Wars Against French Colonialism
- Committee Allocations
    - Ho Chi Minh (VN)
    - Võ Nguyên Giáp (VN)
    - Pham Van Dong (VN)
    - Le Hong Phong (VN)
    - Zhou Enlai (CH)
    - Vyacheslav Molotov (RU)
    - Walter Bedell Smith (US)
    - Archimedes Patti (US)
    - Jean Sainteny (FR)
    - Henri Navarre (FR)
    - Jean de Lattre de Tassigny (FR)
    - Christian de Castries (FR)
    - **Pierre Mendès France (FR)**
    - Bảo Đại (VN)
    - Anthony Eden (UK)

Key Terms (Topic 1)

Term	*Category*	*Definition*
Viet Minh	**Military & Strategic**	• Nationalist and communist coalition led by Ho Chi Minh • "League for the Independence of Vietnam"
French Union	**Military & Strategic**	• Political entity established in 1946 • Replace old colonial empire • Aimed to keep colonies "associated" with France – no full independence
Proxy War	**Military & Strategic**	• Conflict where third-party superpowers (US, Russia, China) support opposing sides to advance their own goals without fighting each other directly
Dien Bien Phu	**Military & Strategic**	• Climactic 1954 battle where French forces under de Castries were surrounded and defeated • Led to the rise of Pierre France as Prime Minister – seeking peace
Guerilla Warfare	**Military & Strategic**	• Irregular warfare where small groups (like Viet Minh) use ambushes, sabotages, and mobility to fight a larger, traditional army
Navarre Plan	**Military & Strategic**	
17th Parallel	**Military & Strategic**	
People's Army of Vietnam (PAVN)	**Military & Strategic**	• Formal military force of Viet Minh • Commanded by Võ Nguyên Giap
Hedgehog Defense	**Military & Strategic**	
Geneva Accords	**Political & Diplomatic**	• Documents that ended the first Indochina war • Provided a ceasefire and the temporary division of Vietnam
State of Vietnam	**Political & Diplomatic**	• Government led by Emporer Bao Đai • Supported by France – non-communist alternative to Viet Minh
Domino Theory	**Political & Diplomatic**	• The geopolitical theory (held strongly by the US) that if Vietnam fell to communism, the rest of Southeast Asia would follow
Sovereignty	**Political & Diplomatic**	• Full rights and power of a governing body over itself
Associated States	**Political & Diplomatic**	• Specific status given to Vietnam, Laos, and Cambodia • Limited self-governance • France retains control of defense and foreign policy

Anti-Colonialism	**Social & Ideological**	
Self-Determination	**Social & Ideological**	
Containment	**Social & Ideological**	• US cold war foreign policy dedicated to stopping the spread of communism → led to the US funding much of France's war efforts
August Revolution	**Social & Ideological**	
Imperialism	**Social & Ideological**	
Demarcation Line	**Social & Ideological**	

Country Stances (Topic 1)

Person	Bloc	Unique Stance

Ho Chi Minh (VN)	***A***	• Goals
		  ○ Total sovereignty for Vietnam, Laos, and Cambodia
		  ○ Reunification of the 3 Vietnamese territories (North, Central, and South/Cochinchina)
		• Strategy
		  ○ Intentionally downplayed the communist ideology to unite all Vietnamese citizens against the French union
		  ○ Initially willing to compromise to prevent a full war
		  ○ Understood the weakness of the newborn state
		• Actions
		  ○ Allowed French troops in the North to replace the Chinese troops – saw it as a means to get rid of the Chinese
		  ■ In exchange for recognition as a free state within the French union
		  ○ Used guerilla warfare as conventional tactics were unfeasible
		  ○ Secured major funding from newly communist China and the Soviet Union after reframing the national goals
		• Results
		  ○ Desire to reunite regions and resistance left the Vietnamese and French at a stalemate

Võ Nguyên Giáp (VN)	***A***	• Goals
		  ○ Sovereignty: total expulsion of French colonial forces from all of Indochina
		  ○ Political consolidation: unified, communist-led Vietnam
		  ○ Peoples war: engaging all civilians in the attack (*RECTIFY*)
		• Strategy
		  ○ Stage 1 (Guerilla): avoid large battles, use hit and run tactics to frustrate the French and force them to spread their troops across thousands of small outposts in the jungle
		  ○ Stage 2 (Equilibrium): once the French are exhausted and the Viet Minh has gained enough weapons (mostly from China) → begin larger, battalion-sized ambushes
		  ○ Stage 3 (General offensive): Viet Minh transitions to a conventional army and destroys the French in a decisive, large-scale set-piece battle
		• Actions
		  ○ Organized “long-distance porters” (civilian peasants) to carry food and ammunition through the jungle – bypassing French controlled roads
		  ○ Ordered troops to melt away, leaving the French to hold empty territory they couldn't supply (due to logistical limitations).
		  ○ Siege of Dien Bien Phu – ordered his men to dismantle heavy artillery and drag it up steep mountains to surround the French from above
		  ■ Unexpected and seemingly impossible
		• Results
		  ○ Forcing the French to stop fighting by exhausting their resources and funds
		  ○ Proved conventional warfare was not the only viable strategy for battle
		  ○ Forced the French to a negotiating table to properly assess the severity and impact of the situation.

Pham Van Dong (VN)	***A***	• Goals
		  ○ Force the world to recognize the DRV (Dem. Rep. of Vietnam)
		  ○ Requires total withdrawal of French forces
		  ○ Requires unification between the 3 regions of Vietnam
		• Strategies
		  ○ Framing the war as an anti-colonial struggle gained the sympathy of newly decolonized nations (India and Indonesia)
		  ○ Delaying negotiations until the French public grows too tired and forces the government to surrender
		  ○ Would talk peace at the table while intensifying the war on the ground
		• Actions
		  ○ 1946 Fontainebleau Conference
		  ■ Chose to return to war as the French refused to grant independence to the South of Vietnam
		  ○ Geneva Accords
		  ■ Led negotiations against Pierre Mendes France
		  ■ Demanded immediate election (unified) → settled for a temporary partition as they knew the Viet Minh would win regardless
		  ○ Building Diplomacy
		  ■ Worked tirelessly to develop formal international diplomatic ties
		• Results
		  ○ Transformed the Viet Minh into an internationally recognized government with allies
		  ○ Longest serving prime minister (30+ years) → proving the success of protracted political strategies.

Le Hong Phong (VN)		
Zhou Enlai (CH)		
Vyacheslav Molotov (RU)		
Walter Bedell Smith (US)		
Archimedes Patti (US)		
Jean Sainteny (FR)		
Henri Navarre (FR)		
Jean de Lattre de Tassigny (FR)		
Christian de Castries (FR)		
Pierre Mendès France (FR)		–

Bảo Đại (VN)		
Anthony Eden (UK)		

Pierre Mendès France

- Wanted honorable exit from the war – maintaining France's prestige
- Recognizes the financial and political toll occurring as a result of the wars.
- 30 days to find peace
- Peace vs. independence
- Pragmatic, limited in time, political gambler
- Focused on finding peace before the fall of the French Fourth Republic
- Lawyer & economist turned politician
- “intellectual“ and “austere”
- Urged the French to drink milk instead of wine to improve national health
- Goal = associate states (Vietnam, Cambodia, Laos)
- 17th parallel
    - Viet Minh gets the North if the French Union preserves a non-communist base (the State of Vietnam) in the South

- Allies:
    - Anthony Eden
    - Walter Bedell Smith
- Rivals
    - Ho Chi Minh
    - Pham Van Dong
- Authority:
    - Recall, Replace Generals
    - Economic redirection
- Issues:
    - Political instability in Paris
    - Military ego in Indochina

- Political instability:
    - Left → vote out for being "imperialist"
    - Right → vote out for “betraying French honor”

Indochinese Independence Wars

- 8 years of bloodshed that reformed Southeast Asia
- Established patterns of conflict that dominated the Cold War Era
- War of decolonization between the French Union and the Vietnamese Independence movement
- Quickly turned into a proxy war – an example of how localized conflicts grow to be global conflicts through military aid
- Communism vs. capitalism
- Revolutionary war – successfully defeated colonial powers through sophisticated political and military strategy
- Nationalism rise
- French Indochina – Vietnam (divided; Tonkin, Annam, Cochinchina), Laos, Cambodia
- Extractive colonial system – exploiting natural resources and using the territory as a market for French goods
    - Provided little educational or political opportunities for the indigenous population → generated widespread resentment and exacerbated nationalist resistance
- Interwar caused the establishment of several nationalist movements
    - Vietnamese Nationalist Party (VNQDD)
    - Indochinese Communist Party (ICP)
        - Founded by Ho Chi Minh in 1930
- Japanese occupation during WWII created opportunity for Vietnamese nationalist groups to organize
- Following Japan's surrender in 1945 – Ho Chi Minh's Viet Minh skillfully filled the power vacuum
    - Coined the Democratic Republic of Vietnam (DRV)
- France was determined to restore colonial control causing inevitable conflict
- Initial negotiations were unsuccessful as both sides remained firm in their polarizing stances
    - Viet Minh : demanding full independence
    - France : insists on maintaining sovereignty within a French Union

- Military egos (French) driven by the need to wash away the shame of France's surrender in WWII

- France viewed Viet Minh as weak compared to the French military

- Ego led to the use of hedgehog camps → led to the defeat
    - Destroyed the "elite" of the French Expeditionary Force

Key Events

- 1954:
    - War consumes 10% of the entire French national budget
    - War consumes 40% of the French military spending
    - Public is exhausted by the dirty war
    - Treasury is empty

Date	Event	Desc	Result
Nov 1946	**Haiphong Incident**	• Point of no return → full-scale war begins • The original tragedy → military aggression is prioritized over diplomatic potential • Signed tentative agreement to allow French troops into the North in exchange for recognizing Vietnam as a "free state" within the French Union ○ Tensions remained regarding the control of tax and customs revenue • French seized Chinese junkboat carrying contraband (resources for Vietnamese survival) → led to a fight due to the trade attempt bypassing French customs and trading not with the French Union but with the Democratic Republic of Vietnam • France then ordered a naval bombardment killing an estimated 6,000 civilians • Destroyed all trust between Ho Chi Minh and the French government → Ho Chi Minh realized that France did not have any interest in a free country but rather in full recolonization	• Evacuation to the north of Vietnam occurred to minimize civilian impact and prepare for a guerilla war. • Guerilla war begins
Oct-Nov 1947	**Operation Lea**	• French Far East Expeditionary Corps launched LÉA • Aimed to strike deep into the Viet Bac (North Tonkin) • Aimed to capture Hô Chí Minh – dismantling the enemies political and military command structure • Combined mass airborne insertions, mechanised thrusts on jungle roads, and a complex riverine advance up the clear (Lô) river • Landmark moment where France combined air, land, and riverine forces in a bold pursuit of a strategic decision • ~15,000 French troops vs. ~35,000 Viet Minh	• Missed the leadership by minutes • Killed 9,000 Viet Minh • Enhanced Vietnamese confidence • Transition to Guerilla warfare
Mar 1949	**The Elysee Accords**	• Agreement signed on March 8th 1949 by ex-emperor of the Nguyen dynasty, Bao Dai – gave the State of Vietnam more independence within the French Union • Increasing the US support of France's actions in Indochina • Fighting communism of Ho Chi Minh while attempting to regain control of their colonies post WWII • Vietnam was empowered to control it's own	•

		finances ● Path paved for the creation of the Vietnamese National Army ● Vietnam granted the right to appoint diplomats to China, Thailand, and the Vatican City	
Oct 1949	**Communist Victory in China**	●	●
Sep-Oct 1950	**Battle of Route Coloniale**	●	●
Dec 1950	**Arrival of de Lattre de Tassigny**	●	●
Nov-Dec 1952	**Battle of Na San**	●	●
May 1953	**Navarre Plan**	●	●
Nov 1953	**Operation Castor**	●	●
March 13 1954	**Siege of Dien Bien Phu**	●	●
May 7 1954	**Fall of Dien Bien Phu**	●	●
Jul 1954	**Geneva Conference and Accords**	●	●

Opening Speech

Honorable Chairs and Fellow Delegates, I refuse to wait for the day that someone wins this inevitable war. Firstly, I urge us to analyze the costs this conflict is going to take on not only our economy but our people and morale as well. We must be aware of the national uprisings that will occur as a result of any action we take. Nationalist protests in Vietnam and imperialist protests in our homeland. Regardless of what we do, there will be outcries for change, thus we must approach this situation with high levels of caution and respect for the individuals risking their lives to reclaim our colonies. Secondly, while Vietnam values their independence, they fail to see the benefits posed by French influence. Southeast Asia without colonies will continue to deteriorate into a communist society that lacks respect for individuality, democracy, and human rights. This is precisely why France needs to remain involved in the Indochinese territories to prevent the rise and spread of communism while encouraging innovation and utilizing the Indochinese market as a means for selling French products. We intend not to manipulate or occupy Vietnam but rather streamline their integration into a world where innovation is abundant and economies thrive without threats of communism. Critically, I propose the immediate establishment of an intergovernmental body – the FIASC – with representatives from each French Union state to achieve compromise in a diplomatic manner that allows for relevant external input. Each day that we allow to pass without an agreement is one step closer to an uncontrollable tragedy. Thank you

(90)

Honorable Chairs and Fellow Delegates, I refuse to wait for the day that someone wins this inevitable war. Firstly, I urge us to analyze the costs this conflict is going to take on not only our economy but our people as well. We must be aware of the nationalist protests in Vietnam and imperialist protests in our homeland that may occur as a result of our actions. Regardless of what we do, there will be outcries for change, thus we must approach this situation with high levels of caution. Secondly, while Vietnam values their independence, they fail to see the benefits posed by French influence. Southeast Asia without colonies will continue to deteriorate into a communist society that lacks respect for individuality, democracy, and human rights. This is precisely why France needs to remain involved in the Indochinese territories', preventing communism while encouraging innovation. We intend not to manipulate or occupy Vietnam but rather streamline their integration into a world where innovation is abundant and economies thrive. I propose the immediate establishment of an intergovernmental body – the FIASC – with representatives from each French Union state to achieve compromise in a diplomatic manner. Each day that we allow to pass without an agreement is one step closer to an uncontrollable tragedy. Thank you

(60)

Position Paper

Pierre Mendès France - HCC (HEXAMUN'26)

Resolution Ideas

- Set fire to jungle – threat
    - Unless ___
- Drug usage → enhance strength, energy, creativity
- Associated states
- FIASC (French Indochina Associated States Commission)
    - Cambodia
    - Laos
    - Vietnam
- Rules of warfare → refer to ICJ if broken
    - No children
    - No chemical warfare/bioterrorism
    - No interception of basic goods (food, water, ammunition)
    - No urban warfare

Motions

- **Motion to extend speaking time to 90 seconds**
- **Motion for __ minutes unmoderated caucus**
- **Motion for __ minutes moderated caucus on the topic of __**
- **Motion for a consultation of the whole for __ minutes on the topic of __**
- **Motion to open debate on resolution __**
- **Motion to adjourn session**
- **Motion to close debate on resolution __**

Topics

- Limiting military engagement to rural areas
- Signing a treaty regarding guerilla warfare and just conflict
- Determining the definition and establishment of associated states
- The consequences of Vietnamese independence
- The consequences of French influence and occupation
- Preventing the spread of communism
- Dividing Vietnam into communist and non-communist territories

POIs

This delegate would like to ask through the chairs,

- How does the delegate plan on ___?
- How does the delegate aim to __?
- Why does the delegate believe __ is necessary?
- What funding does the delegate intend on receiving?
- How does the delegate believe this will have a positive impact?

POCs

This delegate would like to ask through the chairs,

- What does the delegate mean by __?
- Can the delegate elaborate on the impact of __?

- **POI - point of information**
    - **This delegate would like to ask through the chairs ___**
    - Follow up (wait for it to be granted, 1x only)
- **POC - point of clarification**
    - **This delegate would like to ask through the chairs ___**

Topics

Main Sub & Other Speeches

Establishing Rules of Warfare

Honorable Chairs, Esteemed Delegates, I believe we are in a completely unique position where as a military we are stronger than Viet Minh however we stand to lose if we retain our egotistical methods when put up against ruthless, unconventional, and strategic warfare. I strongly urge the committee to establish standards for warfare to prevent unfair, costly, and large-scale conflicts.

Determining the definition of associated states

Consequences of Vietnamese Independence

Consequences of French Influence

Preventing the spread of communism

Dividing Vietnam into non-communist and communist territories